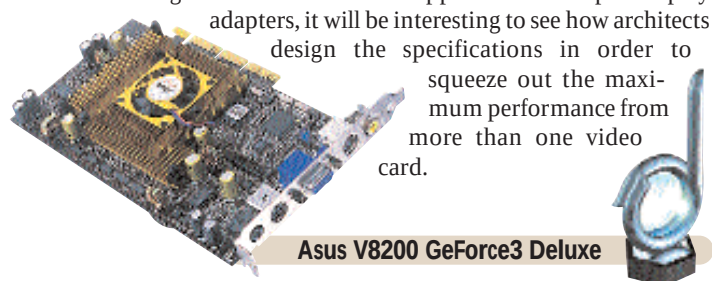


3D GRAPHICS CARDS

You're not a gamer unless you have one of these. Now that frame rates are up to the mark, 3D chip makers are staying focused on keeping the visual experience as real as possible. For this, graphics-processing power is the key. nVidia got it started in the GeForce 3 GPU with Pixel Shaders that add a totally new dimension to graphics detail. Increasing memory speed helps in eliminating bottlenecks at high resolutions and turning up the speed on the graphics core itself pushes up the amount of pixel processing power.

Advancement in 3D technology is among the fastest in the computer industry and the future's extremely exciting! There is no doubt that fill rates will continue to rise exponentially over the next couple of years. We will see different rendering techniques from 3D chip makers, each with their unique visual appeal. But the biggest news in the immediate future is the coming of AGP 8x. With support for multiple display adapters, it will be interesting to see how architects design the specifications in order to squeeze out the maximum performance from more than one video card.



Asus V8200 GeForce3 Deluxe

Gives you unmatched quality without compromising on speed

As far as pure performance is concerned, there's nothing to beat the Asus V8200 GeForce3 Deluxe. The card beats the other cards hands down with its unsurpassed speed and visual quality and also introduces a range of newer features such as per-pixel lighting, which brings stunning results in applications and games that use these features. The provided accessories make the overall package a great buy.

- + Unsurpassed visual quality and speed
- + Plenty of bundled goodies
- + 64 MB of DDR memory

Price: Rs 35,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: September 2001

Worthy Mentions

ASUS V7700 GeForce2 Ultra

- + Ultra fast graphics core
- + TV-out port

Price: Rs 27,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: September 2001

AOpen GeForce2 GTS

- + Good value for money
- + DDR video memory

Price: Rs 9,500
Contact: Yogi Comp
Phone: 022-8806582
Fax: 022-8806582
E-mail: info@yogicomp.com
Reviewed in: September 2001

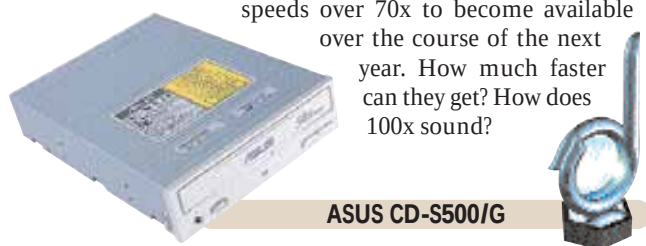
PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Creative 3D Blaster GeForce2 GTS
 1998: Matrox G200 1999: Creative 3D Blaster GeForce

CD-ROMS

Faster rotational speeds result in added performance. This year, CD-ROM drives have hit an astounding 56x, resulting in a maximum 8.4 MBps transfer rate! Increasing spindle speeds and accurate optical technology allow designers the flexibility of maximising peak performance from these optical drives.

As invaluable as the floppy disk once was, the CD-ROM drive is no doubt the *de facto* standard for CD-based storage. Though it will be a standard PC peripheral for the next few years, performance improvements haven't exactly been on the top of manufacturers' minds. While most applications are not in need of anything more than 16x speeds, CD-ROM will continue to

churn out faster models. Look for drives with speeds over 70x to become available over the course of the next year. How much faster can they get? How does 100x sound?



ASUS CD-S500/G

The speed will be obvious while reading multimedia content off the drive and even while installing software and copying from the CD

The ASUS CD-S500/G 50x drive performed so commendably that it proved to be faster even than some of the 56x drives that were tested during the course of the year. With a very good sequential data transfer rate and excellent access times, this drive would prove to be very suitable for applications where there is a lot of sequential data being read.

- + Fast file copy
- + Fast sequential read speeds

Price: Rs 2,150
Contact: Aditya Promoters
Phone: 022-6338555 to 61
Fax: 022-6338554
Reviewed in: November 2001

Worthy Mentions

Acer CD656 56x

- + Good ripping speed; Low price

Price: Rs 1,850
Contact: Acer Peripherals
Phone: 022-570 5230/31/32
Fax: 022-5705235
E-mail: pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw
Reviewed in: November 2001

ASUS CD-S520G/A 52x

- + Good CD Winbench score
- + Fast sequential read speed

Price: Rs 2,250
Contact: Aditya Infotech
Phone: 022-6338555
Fax: 022-6338554
Reviewed in: November 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: ASUS CD-S500 1999: NA 1998: BTC BCD 36XH